the week it was and wear normal clothes to school. But our principal knew of all these tricks, as I was not the only one so disposed. After pardoning us a couple of times, he would send us habitual defaulters back home to change and return, if we did not want to be marked absent. When we used to go for overnight camps, we would often sing the song '*Jayostute*' composed by Veer Savarkar, a most fervent and patriotic song exhorting the people to fight for freedom. I didn't know most of the words and would mostly hum along, but the patriotic fervour in the song was unmistakable.

जयोऽस्तु ते, श्री महन्मंगले शिवास्पदे शुभदे
स्वतंत्रते भगवती त्वामहम् यशोयुतां वंदे!

[Victory to you, Oh! Ever auspicious, munificent and holy Mother!
Oh! Glorious Goddess of Freedom! I seek your blessings for success.]

On the ground floor was an Upasana Mandir (prayer hall) where the upasana would be held on Saturdays. On the rest of the days, we would go up directly to our classes; there was no formal assembly as such. Though founded on the basis of spirituality and Advaita, there was no overemphasis on religion, as the school believed that there was no conflict between spirituality and scientific temper. School was from 11 a.m. to 5 p.m. with a lunch break in between. Post a forty-five-minute break, we used to have a compulsory games period. This break was long enough for those staying close by to go home and have a snack. However, some of us who were boarders or stayed far away, had to do without. JPP did not have any playing fields of its own, so we used to cross Tilak

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